Updated October 27, 2026

Mathieu Bourret Soto

PhD Candidate in Economics

Political Economy | Development | Environmental & Health Economics | Applied Microeconometrics

Email: mathieu.bourret@u-bordeaux.fr | Website: https://mathieubourretsoto.github.io/

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, Bordeaux School of Economics, France 2022–present
"The Institutional Legacy of Violence: Three Essays in the Political Economy of Trust, Attitudes, and Conflict in Latin America"
Defence scheduled: 13 November 2026
Supervisors: Matthieu Clément (BxSE), Éric Rougier (BxSE)
Visiting fellow: NOVAFRICA, Nova SBE, Portugal (sponsor: Victoire Girard) 2025

M.Sc. in Development Economics, CERDI, University Clermont Auvergne, France 2020–2022
Major: sustainable development
Erasmus: University of Göttingen, Germany

B.Sc. in Economics, University of Montpellier, France 2016–2019

JOB MARKET PAPER

"**Civic Expansion and Targeted Violence under Armed Governance: Evidence from Colombia**" (2026).
Draft available: https://mathieubourretsoto.github.io/JMP_MBS.pdf

Abstract. Do grassroots civic institutions protect local leaders from violence, or expose them? Using Colombia's *Juntas de Acción Comunal* (JACs) and a 65-year administrative panel built from the national registry of JACs, I exploit within-municipality variation in annual JAC registrations in a continuous-treatment difference-in-differences design. On the full panel, civic expansion raises subsequent targeted killings of social leaders: the average causal effect is positive and significant, on the order of one additional killing for every ninety new JACs. This effect is concentrated in conflict municipalities and is neutral or protective where armed groups are absent; it is strongest where armed governance is durable, a descriptive gradient identified under stronger assumptions than the baseline. A second finding bounds the threat: killings do not reduce subsequent JAC registrations at any horizon, so targeting does not suppress the formation of new boards, though registration is an imperfect proxy for whether they keep functioning. A leader is targeted for their role in the network, not as an individual, so collective protection is the relevant policy lever.

PUBLICATIONS

"***This is our Legacy*: Youth Exposure to Repression and Trust in Institutions**". *Journal of Institutional Economics*, 22:e47, 2026.
https://doi.org/10.1017/S1744137426100782

"**Understanding Individual Adaptation to Arboviral Diseases Risk: A Systematic Review of Behavioural Determinants of Prevention and Meta-Analysis for non-tropical countries**", with Elisa Delor and Marlène Guillon. *International Journal of Infectious Diseases*, 108845, 2026.
https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijid.2026.108845

"**Prevalence and factors associated with the adoption of heat-adaptive behaviors among residents of a French southern region**", with Marlène Guillon. *Journal of Environmental Psychology*, 109(102883), 2026.
https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jenvp.2025.102883

"**What drives adaptive behaviours during heatwaves? A systematic review with a meta-analysis**", with Marlène Guillon. *Climate Policy*, 24(8), 2024.
https://doi.org/10.1080/14693062.2024.2388225

ONGOING WORK

"***Reunited*? Post-conflict attitudes toward former FARC**", with Thibaut Plassot-Sansans.

"**Fear of Crime in Latin America's Secondary Cities: A Mixed Methods Approach**", with Matthieu Clément and Thibaut Plassot-Sansans.

"**Fear beyond the Metropolis: Insecurity Imaginaries and Perceptions of Security Policies in Latin**

America's Secondary Cities", with Matthieu Clément, Sébastien Cuenot, Thibaut Plassot-Sansans and Éric Rougier.

"**Preferences for arbovirus prevention programmes: a discrete choice experiment among residents of southern France**", with Marlène Guillon.

RECENT WORK EXPERIENCE

Impact Evaluation Consultant, Eval-LAB 2026
Impact evaluation of the French *Dotation Jeune Agriculteur* scheme.
Built a pseudo-panel as longitudinal data could not be accessed within the evaluation timeframe.

Research Assistant, University of Montpellier 2022
Adaptive behaviours during heatwaves, with Marlène Guillon.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, University of Bordeaux
Mathematical Tools & Inferential Statistics, B.Sc. Economics 2024
Computer Science, B.Sc. Economics 2023

WORKSHOPS AND CONFERENCES

2nd Junior Workshop on Economics of Latin America, Berlin, Germany 2026
Workshop on Ibero-American Development, Göttingen, Germany 2025
EEA 2025, Bordeaux, France 2025
Nova SBE PhD Research Group, Lisbon, Portugal 2025
2nd WAP Conference, Bordeaux, France 2025
IT18 Winter School (presentation), Canazei, Italy 2025
WAPLAC Workshop #1, San José, Costa Rica 2024
AFEDEV Doctoral Days, Paris, France 2024
45th JESF Conference, Bordeaux, France 2023
BxSE Doctoral Seminars, Bordeaux, France 2023–2026

PEER REVIEW EXPERIENCE

Journal of Environmental Psychology, Frontiers in Psychiatry

RESEARCH FUNDING

IdEx "Investments for the Future" & Grand Programme de Recherche HOPE, University of Bordeaux / French State 2022–2026
University of Bordeaux Graduate Research Support (UBGRS), research visit to NOVAFRICA, Lisbon 2025
CHANGES Doctoral Research Grant, University of Bordeaux 2023

METHODS, SOFTWARE & LANGUAGES

Methods: quasi-experimental and causal inference for policy evaluation (difference-in-differences with continuous and staggered treatment, matching), construction of georeferenced municipality-year panels, survey and discrete choice experiments, mixed methods and interview analysis, systematic review and meta-analysis.

Software: Stata, R, QGIS, LaTeX.

Languages: French (mother tongue), English (C1), Spanish (B1).

REFERENCES

Olivier Bargain
Full Professor
University of Bordeaux
olivier.bargain[at]u-bordeaux.fr

Matthieu Clément
Full Professor
University of Bordeaux
matthieu.clement[at]u-bordeaux.fr

Marlène Guillon
Assistant Professor
University of Montpellier
marlene.guillon[at]umontpellier.fr